# Complete your application

Please confirm whether or not you need to apply for a visa. You may not need to apply for a new U.S. visa if you already hold a valid U.S. visa of the classification appropriate to your purpose of travel, or hold a passport eligible for travel under the Visa Waiver Program, or if you hold a Canadian passport.

If you do need to apply for a nonimmigrant visa, please follow the steps below.

## How to apply

### Step 1: Know your visa type

For Nonimmigrant Visa applicants:

Determine your visa type by reading Common Nonimmigrant Visas. Each visa type explains the qualifications and application items. Choose the visa type that applies to your situation.

Be sure to review the Visa Waiver Program. If your country participates in the Visa Waiver Program, you do not need to apply for a visa if you are traveling for business or pleasure and will only be staying in the United States for 90 days or less.

### Step 2: Complete your application

Complete the Nonimmigrant Visa Electronic Application (DS-160) form. Be sure to read the Guidelines for Completing the DS-160 Form carefully. All information must be correct and accurate. Once the form is submitted, you cannot make any changes. If you need assistance, please consult an

immigration lawyer or translator. The call center cannot help you complete your DS-160. You will need your DS-160 number to book your appointment.

**Note:** If denied a visa previously please complete a new Nonimmigrant Visa Electronic Application (DS-160) form.

### Step 3: Pay your visa fees

Once you have determined the correct visa type and completed the DS-160, you must pay the visa fee. The visa fee page lists the visa types and correlating visa fee in U.S. dollars and local currency.

To pay your visa fee, read the bank and payment options page. This page explains how to make your visa fee payment. You will create a profile and must keep your receipt number to book your visa appointment.

### Step 4: Schedule your appointment

You are almost ready to schedule your visa appointment! Now you will need to login to your profile with the same credentials you used to pay your visa fee. Once you are in the system, you will see your dashboard.

Select the Schedule Appointment button. This will start the process of paying and scheduling your appointment.

- You must schedule two appointments, one for the Visa Application Center (VAC) and one for the visa interview at the Embassy or Consulate.
- First, schedule your appointment at a Visa Application Center. This appointment will allow you to go to one of the five Visa Application Center locations to have your fingerprints and photo taken. This appointment must be at least **2 business days** before your visa interview appointment at the Embassy or Consulate.
- Second, schedule your visa interview appointment at the Embassy or Consulate.
- Same day appointments can be scheduled for certain visa classes. The VAC appointment time must be prior to the consular appointment time.
- Same day appointments are available for L1 Blanket visas in Chennai and as emergency appointments at all other posts.

You will need three pieces of information in order to schedule your appointment:

- Your passport number
- The visa application fee receipt number.

- The ten (10) digit barcode number from your DS-160 confirmation page

As you go through the process you will be able to select your visa type, enter personal data, add dependents, select your document delivery location, confirm visa payment, and schedule your appointment.

### Step 5: Attend your interview

For your Visa Application Center appointment, you must present:

- A passport valid for travel to the United States with validity dates at least six months beyond your intended period of stay in the United States (unless country-specific agreements provide exemptions). If more than one person is included in your passport, each person desiring a visa must submit an application.
- Your DS-160 confirmation page.
- Your appointment confirmation page.
- One photograph as per U.S. visa specifications if the applicant is under 14 years of age. See photos and fingerprints for more details.

### Step 6: Track your passport

If your visa application is approved, your passport and visa can be collected from the pickup location you selected when you scheduled for interview appointment. When your passport is available at selected location you will receive an email and an SMS that your passport is “Ready for Pick Up”. Domestic and international delivery services to applicant’s address are available as a premium service.

# DS-160 information

Each applicant - including children - must have their own Form DS-160 visa application. The Form DS-160 must be completed and submitted online prior to your interview at the

Embassy or Consulate. The barcode number on the Form DS-160 confirmation page is required in order to book your interview. The Form DS-160 must be submitted online and the printed confirmation page must be brought to the interview. The Embassy or Consulate will not accept handwritten or typed applications and you will not be permitted to attend your interview without a Form DS-160 confirmation page.

When you sign your DS-160 electronically, you are certifying that all the information contained in it is true and correct. Misrepresenting any facts could render you ineligible to enter the United States. Please double-check that all your answers are accurate and that every question is answered completely.

**Note: DS-160 visa application is valid for one year from the date of submission on the Form.**

When completing the 'sex' field of the DS-160, please select your sex at birth: male or female. Generally, this will be the sex listed on your passport. However, if your passport lists your gender identity, does not list a sex, or lists 'X'/'unspecified' in a 'sex'/'gender' field, you must select your sex at birth.

When booking your visa appointment, you must ensure that you, or your representative, submit a properly completed DS-160 form (online visa application).

A properly completed DS-160 form contains the complete and correct information (including name, sex, visa class, date of birth, passport number, et cetera.) for the applicant who will appear for the interview.

Please note:

- If your appointment was booked prior to November 15, 2023, you may proceed with your appointment to the VAC or document drop-off location with your corrected DS-160 confirmation page.
- If your appointment was booked on or after November 15, 2023, you must bring the original DS-160 confirmation page you have used to schedule your appointment AND the corrected DS-160 confirmation page to the VAC or document drop-off location on the day of your appointment. If you are unable to bring your original DS-160 confirmation page and your corrected DS-160 confirmation page, you must cancel and reschedule your appointment by entering your corrected DS-160 application number.

For more information, please visit Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) under DS-160.

All visa applicants must bring a DS-160 visa application form with a confirmation/barcode number (starting with AA) that matches the one used to make their appointment online. If you appear at your appointment and the DS-160 barcode does not match the one in your appointment profile, you will not be able attend your interview. For instructions on updating your DS-160 number, please click here .

## Guidelines for completing the Form DS-160

Complete and submit your Form DS-160 after reviewing the nonimmigrant visa application process. You must submit your DS-160 application online prior to making an appointment for an interview at the Embassy or Consulate.

- The interview Embassy/Consulate you select at the beginning of the Form DS-160 can be different from the Embassy/Consulate where you schedule

your interview appointment. However please note that the Embassy/Consulate must be located within India (New Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad and Kolkata).

- All questions must be answered in English using English-language characters only, except when you are asked to provide your full name in your native alphabet.
- If you stop working on this application for more than 20 minutes, your session will expire. You will have to start over, unless you have recorded your Application ID Number or have saved your application to a file on your computer. Write down the Application ID displayed on the top right-hand corner of the page. If you need to close the browser before submitting your application, you will need this Application ID to continue your application.
- The completed DS-160 application form will generate an alpha-numeric barcode confirmation page. Print this page. The printed confirmation page is required for the appointment at the Visa Application Center and for the interview at the Embassy/Consulate.
- Once you have printed the barcode confirmation page, hit the "Back" button on your web browser and then email yourself a backup copy of the DS-160. The emailed file will be in PDF format, which requires Adobe Acrobat to view or print.

## More Information

Any inquiries on completing the DS-160 will be addressed on DS-160 FAQs. We are unable to answer any questions or provide guidance on this process.

Select here to access Online Nonimmigrant Visa Application, Form DS-160.

# Fingerprints

During the visa process an ink-free, digital fingerprint scan will be quickly taken. All nonimmigrant visa applicants ages 14 to 79 must be fingerprinted, and all immigrant visa (IV) applicants ages 14 and above must be fingerprinted.

There are some applicants whose fingerprints are not required, including:

- Applicants traveling on official government business, except for A-3 and G-5
- Applicants under age 14 or age 80 and over

# Photo requirements

Your visa application photo must meet certain criteria regarding size and content. Submitting photos that do not meet these criteria can delay the visa application process. To reflect your current appearance, your photo must be taken within the last six months. If you are renewing a previous visa, this generally means your photo must not be the same one that appeared on your old visa.

If your photo does not meet the requirements, you will be required to submit a new photo before your visa is processed, even if the visa application system accepted it as a digital photo upload.

### Photo resources on Department of State

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Photo composition
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## General Information

Frequently asked questions (FAQ)
Rights and protections
Helpful links
Holidays and closures
Terms and conditions
Privacy policy
Accessibility

Change location

The U.S. Department of State's Bureau of Consular Affairs website and Consular Post websites are the definitive sources of visa information. Should there be discrepancies in content, the Consular Affairs website and Consular Post websites take precedence.

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